DECCAN STATE ELECTRONICS DEVELOPMENT CORPORATION LIMITED

(A Government of Deccan State Undertaking) - fictional buyer created for a hackathon demonstration

DSEDC Bhavan, 4th Floor, Sector 9, Navapur - 500 901, Deccan State (fictional)

REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL (RFP)

Selection of Managed Service Provider (MSP) for Operation & Maintenance of Deccan State Data Centre (DSDC), Disaster Recovery Site and Network Operations Centre, including Hybrid Cloud Management, for a period of Five Years

RFP No.: **DSEDC/DSDC-MSP/2026/014**

Date of issue: 05-10-2026 at 10:00 hrs

Volume I: Instructions to Bidders, Eligibility and Evaluation

Volume II: Scope of Work and Service Level Agreement

Volume III: General and Special Conditions of Contract

Important notice for this demonstration pack. This RFP is a **simulated document** prepared for the TenderBridge AgentOps 2026 hackathon demonstration. The buyer, Deccan State, Navapur, all reference numbers and all e-mail addresses are fictional. The structure and clause patterns are modelled on public Indian State Data Centre operation and maintenance RFPs and on the standard GFR 2017 / CVC similar-works criterion. It is not an official procurement document and must not be presented as one.

Disclaimer

The information contained in this Request for Proposal (RFP) document, or subsequently provided to Bidders, whether verbally or in documentary form, by or on behalf of DSEDC, is provided to Bidders on the terms and conditions set out in this RFP and such other terms and conditions subject to which such information is provided. This RFP is not an agreement and is neither an offer nor an invitation by DSEDC to the prospective Bidders or any other person. The purpose of this RFP is to provide interested parties with information that may be useful to them in making their proposals.

DSEDC, its employees and advisors make no representation or warranty and shall have no liability to any person, including any Bidder, under any law, statute, rules or regulations or tort, principles of restitution or unjust enrichment or otherwise for any loss, damages, cost or expense which may arise from or be incurred or suffered on account of anything contained in this RFP. DSEDC may, in its absolute discretion but without being under any obligation to do so, update, amend or supplement the information in this RFP through a corrigendum published on the eProcurement portal.

Abbreviations

Term	Meaning
DSDC	Deccan State Data Centre, Navapur (primary site)
DR Site	Disaster Recovery Site at Shivgiri, approximately 610 km from Navapur
NOC	Network Operations Centre co-located at DSDC
MSP	Managed Service Provider, the successful Bidder
EMD	Earnest Money Deposit (bid security)
PBG	Performance Bank Guarantee
QGR	Quarterly Guaranteed Revenue: the fixed quarterly payment payable to the MSP before SLA deductions
QCBS	Quality and Cost Based Selection
MSE	Micro and Small Enterprise as defined under the MSMED Act, 2006 and registered on the Udyam portal
EMS / NMS / ITSM	Enterprise Management System / Network Management System / IT Service Management tool
RPO / RTO	Recovery Point Objective / Recovery Time Objective
TPA	Third Party Auditor appointed by DSEDC
LoA	Letter of Award
CERT-In	Indian Computer Emergency Response Team

Section 1: Invitation for Bids and Fact Sheet

1.1 Deccan State Electronics Development Corporation Limited (DSEDC), on behalf of the Department of Information Technology, Government of Deccan State, invites online bids from eligible bidders for the **Selection of Managed Service Provider (MSP) for Operation & Maintenance of Deccan State Data Centre (DSDC), Disaster Recovery Site and Network Operations Centre, including Hybrid Cloud Management, for a period of Five Years** (the "Project"). Bids shall be submitted only through the Deccan State eProcurement Portal (simulated): https://eproc.deccan.example/.

1.2 The fact sheet below summarises key information. In case of any conflict between the fact sheet and the detailed clauses of this RFP, the detailed clauses shall prevail, and in case of conflict between the RFP and any corrigendum, the latest corrigendum shall prevail.

1.3 Fact Sheet

Sl.	Item	Details
1	RFP reference	DSEDC/DSDC-MSP/2026/014
2	Name of work	Selection of Managed Service Provider (MSP) for Operation & Maintenance of Deccan State Data Centre (DSDC), Disaster Recovery Site and Network Operations Centre, including Hybrid Cloud Management, for a period of Five Years
3	Tendering authority	General Manager (IT Infrastructure), DSEDC, Deccan State Electronics Development Corporation Limited (DSEDC)
4	Estimated cost of the Project	Rs. 38.40 Crore (Rupees Thirty Eight Crore Forty Lakh only), inclusive of all taxes, for five years
5	Tender fee	Rs. 25,000/- (Rupees Twenty Five Thousand only), non-refundable; exempted for eligible MSEs (Clause 2.10)
6	Earnest Money Deposit (EMD)	Rs. 76,80,000/- (Rupees Seventy Six Lakh Eighty Thousand only) in the form of Bank Guarantee / e-BG / online transfer; exempted for eligible MSEs (Clause 2.10)
7	Date of publication and start of download	05-10-2026 at 10:00 hrs
8	Last date for submission of pre-bid queries	13-10-2026 at 17:00 hrs by e-mail to gm-infra@dsedc.example
9	Pre-bid meeting	15-10-2026 at 11:00 hrs, Conference Hall, DSEDC Bhavan, Navapur (also via video conference)
10	Bid submission end date and time	Last date and time for online bid submission: 06-11-2026 at 15:00 hrs
11	Opening of pre-qualification and technical bids	09-11-2026 at 11:00 hrs
12	Technical presentation by qualified bidders	Week commencing 16-11-2026 (tentative; schedule will be intimated)
13	Opening of commercial bids	To be intimated to technically qualified bidders
14	Bid validity	Bids shall remain valid for 180 days from the bid submission end date.
15	Method of selection	QCBS 70:30 (Technical 70%, Financial 30%); minimum technical score 70 out of 100
16	Contract period	Five (5) years from the date of takeover of operations (Go-Live), plus a transition period of up to three (3) months before Go-Live
17	Performance Bank Guarantee	5% of the total contract value, valid for 60 days beyond the contract period
18	Consortium / Joint Venture	Not allowed
19	Contact	General Manager (IT Infrastructure), DSEDC, e-mail: gm-infra@dsedc.example

Section 2: Instructions to Bidders

2.1 Eligible Bidders

2.1.1 This invitation is open to bidders who satisfy the pre-qualification criteria specified in Section 3. Bidders shall provide all documentary evidence called for in Section 3 and in the formats in the Annexures. Claims not supported by documentary evidence shall not be considered.

2.1.2 Bids from a consortium or joint venture shall not be accepted. The Bidder shall be a single legal entity and shall be solely responsible for the delivery of all services under this RFP.

2.1.3 A Bidder shall submit only one bid. A Bidder who submits or participates in more than one bid shall be disqualified.

2.2 Cost of Bidding

The Bidder shall bear all costs associated with the preparation and submission of its bid, including presentations and site visits, and DSEDC shall not be responsible or liable for those costs, regardless of the conduct or outcome of the bidding process.

2.3 Site Visit

Bidders may visit DSDC and the DR Site, with prior permission, between the date of publication and the pre-bid meeting. Requests for a site visit shall be sent by e-mail at least two working days in advance. Bidders shall not be allowed to access production systems or records during a visit.

2.4 Pre-bid Queries and Pre-bid Meeting

2.4.1 Bidders shall submit pre-bid queries only by e-mail to gm-infra@dsedc.example in the MS-Excel format prescribed in Annexure F, on or before 13-10-2026 at 17:00 hrs.

2.4.2 Queries received after the deadline, or not in the prescribed format, may not be answered. DSEDC will publish consolidated responses to queries, without identifying the source of the queries, on the eProcurement portal. Responses to pre-bid queries form part of the RFP only to the extent they are issued as a corrigendum or as a published pre-bid response document.

2.5 Clarifications During Evaluation

DSEDC may, at its discretion, seek clarifications from any Bidder during evaluation. No change in the substance of the bid, including price, shall be sought, offered or permitted. Clarifications shall not be used to supply documents that establish eligibility for the first time, except documents that are of a historical nature and existed on or before the bid submission end date.

2.6 Amendment of RFP (Corrigendum)

2.6.1 At any time before the bid submission end date, DSEDC may, for any reason, modify this RFP by issuing a corrigendum. Corrigenda will be published only on the eProcurement portal and will not be sent individually to bidders.

2.6.2 Every corrigendum shall form an integral part of this RFP. In case of any conflict, the provisions of the latest corrigendum shall prevail over earlier corrigenda and over this RFP.

2.6.3 Bidders shall acknowledge all corrigenda issued by DSEDC in the bid covering letter (Format PQ-1). It shall be the responsibility of the Bidder to check the portal for corrigenda.

2.6.4 DSEDC may, at its discretion, extend the bid submission end date to give bidders reasonable time to take a corrigendum into account. All references in this RFP to the bid submission end date shall then refer to the extended date.

2.7 Language of Bid

The bid and all correspondence and documents relating to the bid shall be in English. Supporting documents in any other language shall be accompanied by a self-attested English translation.

2.8 Documents Comprising the Bid

2.8.1 The bid shall be submitted online in three separate covers:

Cover	Contents	Format reference
Cover 1: Pre-qualification	Covering letter, bidder profile, proof of EMD or MSE exemption, documents for each criterion in Section 3, declarations	Formats PQ-1 to PQ-10
Cover 2: Technical	Technical proposal, approach and methodology, key personnel CVs, manpower deployment plan, tool details, transition and exit plan, compliance to scope	Formats T-1 to T-7
Cover 3: Commercial	Commercial covering letter and price schedule	Format C-1 and C-2 (MS-Excel price schedule)

2.8.2 The pre-qualification and technical covers shall not contain any commercial information. A bid that discloses prices in the pre-qualification or technical cover shall be summarily rejected.

2.8.3 The technical proposal (Format T-1, approach and methodology) shall not exceed 40 pages of A4 size, using a font size of not less than 10 points, excluding CVs and formats.

2.9 Bid Prices

2.9.1 Prices shall be quoted in Indian Rupees only, in the MS-Excel price schedule (Format C-2) uploaded on the portal. Prices shall be inclusive of all duties, levies and taxes except GST, which shall be shown separately.

2.9.2 Prices quoted shall remain firm and fixed for the entire contract period of five years and shall not be subject to any price variation, including on account of changes in minimum wages or exchange rates.

2.9.3 Conditional or alternative prices shall not be accepted. If the price schedule contains a discrepancy between unit price and total price, the unit price shall prevail.

2.10 Earnest Money Deposit (EMD) and Tender Fee

2.10.1 The Bidder shall furnish an EMD of Rs. 76,80,000/- (Rupees Seventy Six Lakh Eighty Thousand only) along with the bid, as a Bank Guarantee or e-Bank Guarantee from a scheduled commercial bank, or by online transfer, valid for 45 days beyond the bid validity period.

2.10.2 Micro and Small Enterprises (MSEs) registered on the Udyam portal for the services being procured are exempted from payment of tender fee and EMD, subject to submission of a valid Udyam Registration Certificate along with the bid. Traders and medium enterprises are not eligible for this exemption.

2.10.3 The original EMD Bank Guarantee (if not an e-BG) shall be submitted in a sealed envelope at DSEDC Bhavan before the bid submission end date. Bids without a valid EMD or a valid MSE exemption shall be rejected.

2.10.4 The EMD of unsuccessful bidders shall be returned within 30 days of award. The EMD of the successful bidder shall be returned on receipt of the Performance Bank Guarantee. The EMD shall be forfeited if a bidder withdraws its bid during the validity period, or if the successful bidder fails to sign the contract or furnish the PBG.

2.11 Format and Signing of Bid

2.11.1 All bid documents shall be digitally signed using a valid Class III Digital Signature Certificate of the authorised signatory, and every page of the scanned documents shall be signed and stamped by the authorised signatory.

2.11.2 The authorised signatory shall be authorised by a Board Resolution and a Power of Attorney in Format PQ-10.

2.11.3 Any interlineation, erasure or overwriting shall be valid only if initialled by the authorised signatory.

2.12 Submission of Bids

2.12.1 Bids shall be submitted online on the eProcurement portal. Bids submitted by e-mail, fax or in physical form shall not be accepted, except the original EMD instrument where applicable.

2.12.2 The portal will not permit submission after the bid submission end date and time. DSEDC shall not be responsible for delays due to portal congestion, bandwidth or any technical issue at the bidder's end. Bidders are advised to upload bids well in advance.

2.12.3 A bidder may modify or withdraw its bid on the portal before the bid submission end date. No bid may be modified after that time.

2.13 Opening of Bids

Pre-qualification and technical covers will be opened online on 09-11-2026 at 11:00 hrs. Bidders may view the opening on the portal. Commercial covers of only technically qualified bidders will be opened, on a date to be intimated.

2.14 Integrity Pact

The Bidder shall sign the Integrity Pact in the format at Annexure C and submit it with the pre-qualification cover. A bid without a signed Integrity Pact shall be rejected.

2.15 Fraud and Corrupt Practices

Bidders shall observe the highest standards of ethics during procurement and execution. DSEDC shall reject a bid, and may debar the bidder, if it determines that the bidder has engaged in corrupt, fraudulent, collusive, coercive or obstructive practices, or has submitted false or forged documents. A false declaration in any format shall be treated as a fraudulent practice.

2.16 Conflict of Interest

A Bidder shall not have a conflict of interest. A Bidder that is, or is affiliated with, the Third Party Auditor of DSDC, or with any OEM whose products it will be required to audit or certify under this contract, shall be considered to have a conflict of interest.

2.17 Award of Contract and Signing

2.17.1 DSEDC shall issue a Letter of Award (LoA) to the bidder with the highest combined QCBS score. Within 15 days of the LoA, the successful bidder shall furnish the Performance Bank Guarantee and sign the contract.

2.17.2 DSEDC reserves the right to accept or reject any bid, and to annul the bidding process and reject all bids at any time before award, without incurring any liability to the affected bidders.

Section 3: Pre-qualification Criteria

3.1 Only bidders that meet all of the following pre-qualification criteria will be considered for technical evaluation. Bidders shall submit documentary evidence for each criterion, with page references in the pre-qualification checklist (Format PQ-1, Schedule A).

3.2 Unless stated otherwise, compliance with each criterion shall be determined as on the bid submission end date.

Sl.	Pre-qualification criterion	Documentary evidence required
PQ-01	The Bidder shall be a company registered in India under the Companies Act, 1956 or the Companies Act, 2013, and shall have been in existence and operation in India for at least five (5) years as on the bid submission end date.	Certificate of Incorporation; Format PQ-2 (Bidder profile)
PQ-02	The Bidder shall have an average annual turnover of not less than Rs. 55 Crore from IT/ITeS services during the last three audited financial years, i.e. 2022-23, 2023-24 and 2024-25. For Micro and Small Enterprises (MSEs) holding a valid Udyam Registration for IT services (NIC division 62 or 63) as on the bid submission end date, the average annual turnover requirement shall be Rs. 45 Crore.	Audited Balance Sheet and Profit and Loss Statement for each of the three financial years; Certificate from statutory auditor / Chartered Accountant in Format PQ-3; Udyam Registration Certificate (for MSE relaxation)
PQ-03	Of the turnover in PQ-02, the average annual turnover from Data Centre, Network and managed IT infrastructure services during the same three financial years shall be not less than Rs. 20 Crore.	Chartered Accountant certificate in Format PQ-3 showing segment-wise turnover
PQ-04	The Bidder shall have a positive net worth in each of the last three audited financial years (2022-23, 2023-24 and 2024-25).	Audited Balance Sheets; CA certificate in Format PQ-3
PQ-05	The Bidder shall have successfully completed similar works during the last seven (7) years ending on the last day of the month previous to the one in which bids are invited, i.e. between 01-10-2019 and 30-09-2026, as under: (a) three similar completed works, each costing not less than 40% of the estimated cost, i.e. Rs. 15.36 Crore each; OR (b) two similar completed works, each costing not less than 60% of the estimated cost, i.e. Rs. 23.04 Crore each; OR (c) one similar completed work costing not less than 80% of the estimated cost, i.e. Rs. 30.72 Crore.	Work order / contract, and completion certificate from the client, in Format PQ-4, for each work cited
PQ-06	The Bidder shall possess the following certifications, each valid as on the bid submission end date: (i) ISO 9001:2015; AND (ii) ISO/IEC 27001:2022 with scope covering data centre or IT infrastructure managed services; AND (iii) either CMMI Maturity Level 3 or above (DEV or SVC) OR ISO/IEC 20000-1:2018.	Copies of valid certificates with scope; Format PQ-5
PQ-07	The Bidder shall have at least 150 technically qualified IT professionals (B.E./B.Tech/MCA/M.Sc IT or equivalent) on its payroll as on 30-09-2026.	Certificate from the Bidder's HR head and authorised signatory with employee count as on 30-09-2026
PQ-08	The Bidder shall have an operational office in Deccan State. If the Bidder does not have such an office, it shall submit an undertaking to establish an office in Navapur within 60 days of issue of the Letter of Award, in Format PQ-9.	Proof of office address (GST registration / lease deed), or undertaking in Format PQ-9
PQ-09	The Bidder shall not be blacklisted or debarred by any Ministry or Department of the Government of India, any State Government or any Public Sector Undertaking as on the bid submission end date.	Self-declaration in Format PQ-6
PQ-10	The Bidder shall submit a bid-specific Manufacturer's Authorisation Form (MAF) from the OEM of the proposed EMS/NMS and ITSM tool, with an undertaking of back-to-back support for the contract period, in Format PQ-8.	MAF from OEM in Format PQ-8
PQ-11	The Bidder shall comply with the restrictions under Rule 144(xi) of the General Financial Rules, 2017 on procurement from bidders from a country sharing a land border with India, and shall submit the certificate in Format PQ-7.	Certificate in Format PQ-7
PQ-12	The Bidder shall submit the EMD as per Clause 2.10, or a valid MSE exemption.	EMD instrument, or Udyam Registration Certificate

3.3 Notes to the Pre-qualification Criteria

3.3.1 "Similar work" means Operation & Maintenance or Facility Management Services of a Data Centre or Disaster Recovery site of at least 20 racks, or of a 24x7 Network Operations Centre, executed for a Central or State Government Department, Public Sector Undertaking, Government autonomous body, Urban Local Body or Scheduled Commercial Bank in India.

3.3.2 Only completed works shall be considered. Ongoing works, works covering only Annual Maintenance Contract (AMC) of equipment, and in-house or captive works shall not be considered.

3.3.3 The cost of a work shall be the value of the work executed by the Bidder, including taxes, as stated in the completion certificate. Where the work was executed as a member of a consortium, the value of the work executed by the Bidder shall be considered.

3.3.4 The date of completion shall be the date stated in the completion certificate issued by the client. Where a work was completed within the period stated in PQ-05 but commenced earlier, the work shall be considered.

3.3.5 Values in foreign currency shall be converted into Indian Rupees at the RBI reference rate on the date of the completion certificate. Values expressed in lakh shall be read as 1 Crore = 100 lakh.

3.3.6 Financial years shall be read as April to March. Provisional or unaudited figures shall not be accepted for PQ-02 to PQ-04.

Section 4: Technical Evaluation Criteria

4.1 Bids that meet all the pre-qualification criteria will be evaluated on the following criteria. A bidder must score at least 70 marks out of 100 in the technical evaluation to qualify for opening of its commercial bid.

Sl.	Criterion	Marking scheme	Max marks
T1	Average annual turnover from IT/ITeS services (FY 2022-23 to 2024-25)	Below Rs. 55 Cr (MSEs under relaxation): 2; Rs. 55 Cr to Rs. 75 Cr: 3; above Rs. 75 Cr to Rs. 100 Cr: 4; above Rs. 100 Cr: 5	5
T2	Number of similar completed works (as defined in Clause 3.3.1) each of value not less than Rs. 10 Crore, completed between 01-10-2019 and 30-09-2026	1 work: 5; 2 works: 7; 3 works: 9; 4 or more works: 10	10
T3	Additional certifications valid as on the bid submission end date	ISO/IEC 20000-1:2018: 3; CMMI Maturity Level 5: 3, Level 4: 2, Level 3: 1; ISO 22301:2019: 2	8
T4	Technically qualified IT professionals on payroll as on 30-09-2026	150 to 250: 4; 251 to 400: 4.5; above 400: 5	5
T5	Qualification and experience of key personnel (Clause 4.3)	Project Manager: 7; DC Operations Lead: 5; Network Lead: 5; Security Lead: 4; Cloud Lead: 4	25
T6	Approach and methodology (Format T-1)	Understanding of scope, O&M methodology, ITIL processes, tools, security operations, DR approach, innovation	20
T7	Transition and exit management plan (Format T-6)	Takeover plan, knowledge transfer, risk mitigation, exit plan	7
T8	Technical presentation	Clarity, solution fit, team interaction (presentation by proposed Project Manager is mandatory)	20
	Total		**100**

4.2 Evaluation of Key Personnel

4.2.1 All key personnel proposed shall be on the payroll of the Bidder as on the bid submission end date.

4.2.2 A key personnel CV that does not meet the minimum qualification in Clause 4.3 shall be awarded zero marks, and the Bidder shall be required to replace the person with a person meeting the minimum qualification before signing of the contract.

4.2.3 Professional certifications claimed for key personnel shall be valid as on the bid submission end date, and copies shall be enclosed with the CV in Format T-2.

4.2.4 The proposed Project Manager shall make the technical presentation. Key personnel shall not be replaced during the first twelve months of the contract except for death, medical incapacity or resignation, and any replacement shall have equal or better qualifications.

4.3 Minimum Qualification of Key Personnel

Role	Minimum qualification and experience (mandatory)	Preferred (additional marks)
Project Manager (1, onsite)	B.E./B.Tech/MCA; at least 15 years of total IT experience including at least 8 years in data centre or IT infrastructure O&M; valid PMP or PRINCE2 Practitioner certification.	MBA; experience as PM of a State Data Centre
DC Operations Lead (1, onsite)	B.E./B.Tech; at least 10 years of experience including at least 6 years in data centre operations; ITIL v4 Foundation or higher certification.	Uptime Institute accreditation
Network Lead (1, onsite)	B.E./B.Tech; at least 10 years of experience in data centre and WAN networking; valid CCNP or equivalent certification.	Valid CCIE
Security Lead (1, onsite)	B.E./B.Tech; at least 10 years of experience including at least 5 years in security operations; valid CISSP or CISM certification.	ISO/IEC 27001 Lead Auditor

Role	Minimum qualification and experience (mandatory)	Preferred (additional marks)
Cloud Lead (1, onsite)	B.E./B.Tech; at least 8 years of experience including at least 4 years in cloud infrastructure; valid professional-level cloud architect certification (AWS Solutions Architect Professional, Microsoft Azure Solutions Architect Expert or Google Professional Cloud Architect).	OpenStack or VMware certification

4.3.1 A key personnel CV meeting the minimum qualification shall be awarded 60% of the marks for that role. The balance 40% shall be awarded as follows: 20% for the preferred qualification, and 20% for experience above the minimum at 4% per additional year, up to five years.

Section 5: Commercial Evaluation and Selection

5.1 Commercial bids of bidders that score at least 70 marks in technical evaluation shall be opened. The evaluated bid price shall be the total of the price schedule (Format C-2) for five years, excluding GST.

5.2 The combined score shall be computed as: Combined Score = 0.70 x Tn + 0.30 x Fn, where Tn = (technical score of the bidder / highest technical score) x 100, and Fn = (lowest evaluated bid price / evaluated bid price of the bidder) x 100.

5.3 The bidder with the highest combined score shall be declared the successful bidder. In case of a tie, the bidder with the higher technical score shall be preferred.

5.4 If the evaluated bid price of the successful bidder is more than 20% below the estimated cost, DSEDC may seek a detailed justification and an additional performance security of up to 5% of the contract value.

5.5 Purchase preference to MSEs and Make in India provisions shall apply only to the extent applicable to services under the policies of the Government of Deccan State. This procurement is of a composite service and is not divisible.

Section 6: Scope of Work

6.1 Background

6.1.1 DSDC was commissioned in 2016 at Navapur as a Tier-III-designed facility to host the e-governance applications of the Government of Deccan State. The DR Site at Shivgiri was commissioned in 2019. DSDC also hosts the State Network Operations Centre that monitors the Deccan State Wide Area Network. The current operator's contract ends on 31-03-2027.

6.1.2 Current infrastructure at a glance (detailed inventory in Annexure A):

Item	DSDC Navapur	DR Site Shivgiri
Racks (installed / used)	120 / 96	40 / 31
Physical servers	640	182
Virtual machines	2,450 (VMware) + 380 (OpenStack)	760 (VMware)
Usable storage	3.2 PB (block, file and object)	1.1 PB
Backup	Disk-to-disk-to-tape, 2 tape libraries	Disk-based
Hosted applications	184 applications of 62 departments; 42 Category A (critical)	42 Category A applications replicated
Internet bandwidth	2 x 10 Gbps from two service providers	2 x 2 Gbps
Security stack	Next-generation firewalls, WAF, IPS, DDoS mitigation, SIEM, PAM, EDR	Firewalls, IPS, PAM

6.2 Overview of Services

The MSP shall provide comprehensive operation and maintenance of the IT infrastructure at DSDC, the DR Site and the State NOC, and management of the State hybrid cloud, for five years, as described below. Physical facility management (power, cooling, fire suppression, civil works) is out of scope and is provided by a separate agency, but the MSP shall coordinate with that agency for all incidents with facility impact.

6.3 Transition and Takeover

6.3.1 The MSP shall complete takeover of operations from the current operator within 90 days of the Letter of Award, including inventory verification, knowledge transfer, shadowing for at least 30 days and reverse shadowing for at least 15 days.

6.3.2 The MSP shall submit a transition plan within 15 days of the LoA. Takeover shall be declared complete only on written acceptance by DSEDC after a readiness review.

6.3.3 During transition the MSP shall verify the asset inventory in Annexure A and report discrepancies to DSEDC within 30 days of the LoA. Assets not reported within this period shall be deemed to have been taken over in working condition.

6.4 Data Centre and DR Site Operations

6.4.1 The MSP shall operate DSDC and the DR Site on a 24x7x365 basis. Services include:

- Server administration (Windows, RHEL, Ubuntu, AIX) including OS hardening, patching, performance tuning and capacity management.
- Virtualisation and private cloud administration: VMware vSphere, vSAN and NSX; OpenStack (Yoga or later) including Nova, Neutron, Cinder and Swift.
- Storage administration: SAN, NAS and object storage, LUN provisioning, replication and storage capacity reporting.
- Database support (L1/L2): Oracle, PostgreSQL, MySQL and MS SQL Server: availability, backups, patching and performance monitoring. Application-level support remains with departments.

- Network and security device management within DSDC: core and access switches, load balancers, firewalls, WAF, IPS and DDoS appliances.
- Coordination with OEMs for warranty and AMC support, including logging of calls and tracking until closure.

6.4.2 The MSP shall apply critical security patches to operating systems, hypervisors and network devices within 7 days of release by the OEM, after testing in the staging environment, and shall document any exception approved by DSEDC.

6.4.3 The MSP shall conduct capacity planning reviews every quarter and submit a capacity report with 12-month projections for compute, storage, network and backup.

6.5 Backup and Disaster Recovery

6.5.1 The MSP shall perform backups as per the backup policy approved by DSEDC, and shall perform a test restoration of at least 5% of backed-up systems every month.

6.5.2 The MSP shall maintain replication of all Category A applications to the DR Site with an RPO of not more than 15 minutes and an RTO of not more than 4 hours.

6.5.3 The MSP shall conduct a DR drill every quarter, including at least one full switchover of all Category A applications to the DR Site every year, and shall submit a drill report within 7 days.

6.6 Network Operations Centre

6.6.1 The MSP shall operate the State NOC 24x7 to monitor the Deccan State Wide Area Network (approximately 1,200 points of presence), DSDC internet links and links to the DR Site, using the NMS supplied under this contract.

6.6.2 The MSP shall log every network incident in the ITSM tool, coordinate with bandwidth service providers for restoration, and publish a daily network health report by 10:00 hrs.

6.7 Hybrid Cloud Management

6.7.1 The State hybrid cloud consists of the DSDC private cloud (VMware and OpenStack) and capacity on a cloud service provider empanelled by MeitY. The MSP shall provide a self-service portal for departments, manage provisioning workflows, and produce monthly cost and usage reports.

6.7.2 All data of the Government of Deccan State, including backups and logs, shall be stored only in data centres located in India, and public cloud capacity shall be used only from cloud service providers empanelled by MeitY.

6.8 Security Operations

6.8.1 The MSP shall provide 24x7 L1 and L2 security monitoring using the existing SIEM, including use-case tuning, triage of alerts, and escalation of confirmed incidents to DSEDC within 30 minutes.

6.8.2 The MSP shall maintain an Information Security Management System for DSDC aligned to ISO/IEC 27001:2022 and shall support DSEDC in obtaining and maintaining ISO/IEC 27001 certification of DSDC.

6.8.3 The MSP shall close critical vulnerabilities identified in VAPT within 7 days and high vulnerabilities within 15 days of the report, or record a risk acceptance approved by DSEDC.

6.9 Tools: EMS, NMS and ITSM

6.9.1 The MSP shall supply, install and maintain for the contract period an integrated EMS, NMS and ITSM tool with perpetual or subscription licences in the name of DSEDC, ITIL 4-aligned incident, problem, change, configuration and service request management, and an SLA dashboard accessible to DSEDC.

6.9.2 The SLA dashboard shall compute service levels automatically from tool data. Manually computed SLA reports shall not be accepted except for parameters that cannot be measured by the tool, as agreed with DSEDC.

6.10 Manpower Deployment

6.10.1 The MSP shall deploy, at a minimum, the onsite manpower in Table 6.10 throughout the contract period. The deployment shall be maintained on a shift basis to provide 24x7 coverage.

Table 6.10: Minimum onsite manpower

Sl.	Role	Location	Minimum number	Shift
1	Project Manager (key)	DSDC	1	General
2	DC Operations Lead (key)	DSDC	1	General
3	Network Lead (key)	DSDC	1	General
4	Security Lead (key)	DSDC	1	General
5	Cloud Lead (key)	DSDC	1	General
6	Shift In-charge	DSDC	3	24x7
7	L2 Server / Virtualisation Engineer	DSDC	8	24x7
8	L2 Network Engineer	DSDC / NOC	6	24x7
9	L2 Storage and Backup Engineer	DSDC	4	24x7
10	L2 Security Analyst	DSDC	4	24x7
11	L1 NOC Operator	NOC	12	24x7
12	Database Administrator (L2)	DSDC	2	General + on-call
13	Helpdesk Agent	DSDC	6	24x7
14	DR Site Engineer	DR Site	4	24x7

6.10.2 Onsite engineers shall hold at least a diploma in engineering or a graduate degree with relevant OEM certification. The MSP shall submit monthly attendance records generated from the biometric system of DSEDC.

6.11 Reporting and Governance

6.11.1 The MSP shall submit the monthly SLA and performance report by the 7th day of the following month, and shall attend the monthly review meeting chaired by DSEDC.

6.11.2 The MSP shall support the Third Party Auditor appointed by DSEDC in quarterly SLA audits and annual security audits, and shall close audit observations within the timelines agreed with DSEDC.

6.11A Service Management Processes

The MSP shall implement the following ITIL 4-aligned practices in the ITSM tool within 60 days of Go-Live, document them in a process manual approved by DSEDC, and review them every year.

Practice	Minimum requirements
Incident management	Single point of contact; priority matrix (P1 to P4) based on impact and urgency agreed with DSEDC; automatic ticket creation from EMS/NMS alerts; major incident procedure with bridge call within 15 minutes for P1.
Problem management	Root cause analysis report for every P1 incident within 5 working days; known error database; quarterly trend analysis.
Change management	Change Advisory Board meeting weekly; emergency change procedure; no change to production without approval in the ITSM tool; post-implementation review for failed changes.
Configuration management	CMDB populated through auto-discovery covering 100% of servers, network and security devices within 90 days of Go-Live; monthly reconciliation with asset register.
Service request management	Service catalogue for departments (VM provisioning, firewall rule request, backup request, user access); self-service portal; fulfilment targets per catalogue item.
Capacity and availability management	Monthly utilisation reports; alerts at 70% and 85% thresholds; quarterly capacity plan (Clause 6.4.3).
Information security management	ISMS documentation, access reviews every quarter, privileged access only through PAM, log review.

Practice	Minimum requirements
Service continuity management	DR runbooks for each Category A application, updated after every drill and every major change.

6.11B Helpdesk

6.11B.1 The MSP shall operate a 24x7 helpdesk for departments, reachable by toll-free telephone number, e-mail and the self-service portal, and shall ensure that 90% of calls are answered within 60 seconds.

6.11B.2 The helpdesk shall operate in English, Hindi and the official language of Deccan State. Customer satisfaction surveys shall be conducted every quarter and results reported to DSEDC.

6.11C Documentation

The MSP shall prepare and keep current: standard operating procedures for each technology tower, network diagrams, DR runbooks, the CMDB, the shift handover log, the risk register and the exit management plan. All documentation shall be stored in the document repository of DSEDC and shall be the property of DSEDC.

6.11D Compliance and Audits

6.11D.1 The MSP shall support DSEDC in the following audits and certifications for DSDC: ISO/IEC 27001 surveillance and recertification audits, STQC or CERT-In empanelled auditor security audits, and the annual audit of SLA computation by the TPA.

6.11D.2 The MSP shall ensure that its own ISO/IEC 27001:2022 certification, with scope covering the services delivered under this contract, remains valid throughout the contract period, and shall submit a copy of each renewed certificate to DSEDC within 15 days of issue.

6.12 Exit Management

6.12.1 The MSP shall submit a detailed exit management plan within 90 days of Go-Live, update it annually, and provide exit support for six months before the end of the contract, including knowledge transfer and handover of all configurations, documentation and credentials to DSEDC or its nominated agency.

Section 7: Service Level Agreement and Penalties

7.1 Service levels shall be measured monthly through the EMS/ITSM tool, and penalties shall be deducted quarterly from the Quarterly Guaranteed Revenue (QGR). Planned downtime approved in advance by DSEDC shall be excluded from availability calculations.

Sl.	Service level parameter	Target	Penalty
S1	Availability of DSDC IT infrastructure (servers, storage, network, security devices), measured monthly	>= 99.95%	1% of QGR for every 0.05% (or part) below target
S2	Availability of DR Site infrastructure, measured monthly	>= 99.5%	0.5% of QGR for every 0.1% (or part) below target
S3	Availability of NOC monitoring and NMS	>= 99.9%	0.5% of QGR for every 0.1% (or part) below target
S4	Priority 1 incident: response / resolution	Response within 15 minutes; resolution within 4 hours	0.25% of QGR per incident per hour (or part) of delay
S5	Priority 2 incident: response / resolution	Response within 30 minutes; resolution within 8 hours	0.1% of QGR per incident per hour (or part) of delay
S6	RPO / RTO for Category A applications during drill or actual disaster	RPO <= 15 minutes; RTO <= 4 hours	2% of QGR per application per breach
S7	Quarterly DR drill	One drill per quarter, report within 7 days	1% of QGR per missed drill
S8	Backup success rate (monthly)	>= 99%	0.5% of QGR for every 1% (or part) below target
S9	Critical patch compliance	100% within 7 days of OEM release (excluding approved exceptions)	0.25% of QGR per device-week of delay, capped at 2% per quarter
S10	Absence of key personnel without approved replacement	Nil	Rs. 10,000 per key person per day of absence beyond 3 days in a month
S11	Monthly SLA report	By the 7th day of the following month	Rs. 5,000 per day of delay

7.2 The total SLA penalty in a quarter shall be capped at 15% of the QGR for that quarter. If the penalty reaches the cap in two consecutive quarters, DSEDC may terminate the contract for default.

7.3 Penalties under this Section are in addition to, and not in substitution of, liquidated damages under Clause 8.5 and other remedies of DSEDC.

7.3A Measurement Definitions

Availability (%) = (Total minutes in the month - Downtime minutes) / Total minutes in the month x 100, where downtime is the period during which a component or service is not available for use, measured from the time of the alert or the ticket, whichever is earlier, to the time of restoration confirmed in the ITSM tool. Downtime of redundant components that does not affect service shall not be counted.

Response time is the time from the logging of an incident to the first meaningful action by an assigned engineer recorded in the ITSM tool. Resolution time is the time from logging to restoration of service, excluding time awaiting a response from DSEDC or departments.

Illustration: if the QGR is Rs. 1.80 Crore and monthly availability of DSDC IT infrastructure is 99.87%, the shortfall of 0.08% is two blocks of 0.05% (or part), so the penalty is 2% of QGR, i.e. Rs. 3.60 lakh, subject to the quarterly cap in Clause 7.2.

7.4 SLA parameters may be reviewed by DSEDC after the first year of operations in consultation with the MSP, without any change in the price.

Section 8: General Conditions of Contract

8.1 Definitions and Order of Precedence

The contract documents shall be read in the following order of precedence: (a) the Contract Agreement; (b) corrigenda and pre-bid responses, the latest prevailing; (c) the Special Conditions of Contract; (d) these General Conditions; (e) the Scope of Work and SLA; (f) the MSP's technical and commercial bid as accepted by DSEDC.

8.2 Term of Contract

The contract shall be valid for five years from Go-Live, plus the transition period. DSEDC may extend the contract by up to one year on the same terms and prices, by written notice at least 90 days before expiry.

8.3 Performance Bank Guarantee

The MSP shall furnish a Performance Bank Guarantee of 5% of the total contract value from a scheduled commercial bank, valid for 60 days beyond the end of the contract period, within 15 days of the Letter of Award.

8.4 Payment Terms

Payment of the QGR shall be made quarterly in arrears, within 60 days of receipt of a correct invoice together with the SLA report verified by DSEDC or its TPA, after deduction of applicable penalties.

8.4.1 Transition costs, if quoted, shall be paid on successful takeover. Tool licence costs shall be paid on installation and acceptance, and annual technical support for tools shall be paid annually in advance against a bank guarantee of equal value.

8.5 Liquidated Damages

If the MSP fails to complete takeover within the period in Clause 6.3.1, DSEDC shall levy liquidated damages of 0.5% of the annual contract value per week of delay or part thereof, subject to a maximum of 10% of the annual contract value.

8.6 Limitation of Liability

Save for the exceptions below, the aggregate liability of the MSP under or in connection with this Contract shall not exceed the total contract value. The above limitation shall not apply to, and the liability of the MSP shall be unlimited for: (a) damages arising from gross negligence or wilful misconduct; (b) any breach of data protection or confidentiality obligations, including any data breach attributable to the MSP; and (c) indemnity for infringement of third-party intellectual property rights.

Neither party shall be liable to the other for indirect or consequential losses, except in the cases listed in (a) to (c) above.

8.7 Indemnity

The MSP shall indemnify DSEDC against all third-party claims, losses and damages arising from the MSP's breach of contract, negligence, breach of law, or infringement of intellectual property rights in the deliverables or tools supplied by the MSP.

8.8 Intellectual Property

All deliverables, configurations, scripts, runbooks, documentation and other work products created under this Contract shall be the exclusive property of DSEDC. The MSP shall grant DSEDC a perpetual, irrevocable, royalty-free licence to use any pre-existing tools or materials of the MSP embedded in the deliverables.

8.9 Confidentiality and Data Protection

The MSP shall comply with the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023, the Information Technology Act, 2000 and the rules and directions issued under them, and shall process personal data only on the documented instructions of DSEDC.

The MSP shall ensure that its personnel sign non-disclosure undertakings, and that no data, logs or configuration is copied out of DSDC except with the written approval of DSEDC.

8.10 Audit and Inspection

DSEDC, its TPA, STQC or any agency appointed by the Government shall have the right to audit the MSP's processes, records and facilities related to this contract, with reasonable notice. The MSP shall maintain records for at least three years after the end of the contract.

8.11 Subcontracting

The MSP shall not subcontract any part of the services without the prior written approval of DSEDC. Key personnel roles and 24x7 operations staff shall not be subcontracted.

8.12 Termination

8.12.1 DSEDC may terminate the contract for default by giving 30 days' written notice if the MSP fails to perform any obligation and does not cure the failure within the notice period, or if penalties reach the cap as stated in Clause 7.2.

8.12.2 DSEDC may terminate the contract, in whole or in part, for its convenience by giving the MSP 60 days' written notice. The MSP shall be paid for services rendered up to the date of termination.

8.12.3 On termination for any reason, the MSP shall provide exit support as per Clause 6.12.

8.13 Force Majeure

Neither party shall be liable for delay or failure to perform caused by force majeure events, provided that the affected party notifies the other within 7 days of the event. If force majeure continues for more than 90 days, either party may terminate the contract by written notice.

8.14 Insurance

The MSP shall maintain, for the contract period, professional indemnity insurance of not less than Rs. 10 Crore and cyber liability insurance of not less than Rs. 10 Crore, and shall submit copies of the policies within 30 days of the LoA.

8.15 Settlement of Disputes and Governing Law

Disputes shall first be resolved by mutual discussion. Unresolved disputes shall be referred to arbitration by a sole arbitrator under the Arbitration and Conciliation Act, 1996. The seat and venue of arbitration shall be Navapur. The contract shall be governed by the laws of India, and the courts at Navapur shall have exclusive jurisdiction.

Section 9: Special Conditions of Contract

9.1 The MSP shall report cyber security incidents to CERT-In and to DSEDC as required by the directions issued by CERT-In under Section 70B of the Information Technology Act, 2000.

9.2 All logs of ICT systems shall be retained securely within India for a rolling period of 180 days, or longer if required by DSEDC.

9.3 The MSP shall not use any tool, agent or software that sends data from DSDC to a location outside India, including telemetry, without the prior written approval of DSEDC.

9.4 Background verification, including police verification, shall be completed for all personnel deployed at DSDC and the DR Site before deployment.

9.5 List of Formats and Annexures (separate document)

Reference	Title
PQ-1	Covering letter with pre-qualification checklist (Schedule A) and acknowledgement of corrigenda
PQ-2	Bidder profile
PQ-3	Financial capability: turnover, segment turnover and net worth (CA certificate)
PQ-4	Similar work citation
PQ-5	Certifications held
PQ-6	Declaration of non-blacklisting
PQ-7	Certificate regarding bidders from countries sharing a land border with India
PQ-8	Manufacturer's Authorisation Form (MAF)
PQ-9	Undertaking to establish local office
PQ-10	Power of Attorney for authorised signatory
T-1 to T-7	Technical formats: approach and methodology, CV, manpower deployment, compliance to scope, tool details, transition and exit plan, deviations
C-1, C-2	Commercial covering letter and price schedule (MS-Excel)
Annexure A to F	Asset inventory, application categories, Integrity Pact, PBG format, draft contract agreement, pre-bid query format

End of RFP document. Formats and annexures are issued as a separate document (annexures.pdf) and the price schedule as an MS-Excel file.